Poland: energy security, economic opportunity and partnership priorities

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AI-generated from the data and checked against it; paper baseline as of 12 October 2026.

Summary

- Poland is most exposed in upstream oil and downstream nuclear, where its Energy Security is higher than only 17% and 26% of the other economies scored. In upstream oil, a production shortfall and no recorded reserves pull the score down.[1]
- Its strongest openings are in midstream coal, midstream wind and midstream electric grid, where its Economic Opportunity is higher than 99%, 98% and 98% of the other economies scored. Trade pushes up the coal and grid scores, and investment the wind score.[1]
- On the paper's weighting, the Strategic Index puts upstream nuclear 1st among Poland's own sectors; its policy activity is in the "middle" group.[1]
- The Partnership Strength Index rates Germany highest for Poland, as an export market; it is also Poland's 1st trade partner. China ranks 2nd among its trade partners but 46th on Partnership Strength.[1,2]

1. Energy security risks and why

Energy Security measures how well a country can rely on what it needs in a sector, compared with other economies. Of Poland's 30 placed sectors (those comparable on both scores), 4 sit in the two low-energy-security corners: all 4 in the Upgrade corner and none in the Secure corner. The Upgrade corner pairs high opportunity with low energy security. Compared with other economies in each sector, its Energy Security is lowest in upstream oil (0.37) and downstream nuclear (0.35), both in the Upgrade corner. It scores higher than only 17% and 26% of the other 96 and 66 economies scored in these sectors.[1]

Its high-priority sectors, chosen from the Upgrade corner by Strategic Index rank, are downstream nuclear, upstream gas and upstream oil. In upstream oil, energy imports and reserves pull the score down: oil production minus consumption was -1.42 EJ in 2025, and no proved oil reserves are recorded, which the index counts as zero. For context, its largest suppliers in 2024 were Saudi Arabia (35.9% of imports totalling USD 22.7 bn), Norway (20.2%) and the United States (13.6%).[1,2,3,4]

In upstream gas, also in the Upgrade corner, its Energy Security is higher than 46% of the other 97 economies scored. Energy imports pull it down: gas production minus consumption was -0.673 EJ in 2025. In downstream nuclear, no category stands apart from the middle economy, and 41.7% of the score's weight rests on filled-in data.[1,3]

2. Economic opportunities and why

Economic Opportunity measures how well placed a country is to create value in a sector, from exports and related capabilities to investment, costs and demand. Of the 30 placed sectors, 29 sit in the two high-

opportunity corners: 25 in the Grow corner, with high energy security, and 4 in the Upgrade corner. Its Economic Opportunity ranks highest in midstream coal, midstream wind and midstream electric grid, higher than 99%, 98% and 98% of the other 154, 64 and 92 economies scored.[1]

Trade pushes midstream coal up: its share of world exports was 13.5% in 2023, and its exports USD 2.45 bn in 2024. In midstream wind, investment and foreign dependency push the score up. It scores higher than 97% of the other economies on annual investment. The foreign-dependency figure, a 2035 share of world manufacturing capacity of 15.0%, is the EU's announced share, carried by each EU member. In midstream electric grid, trade and input costs push it up: exports were USD 9.47 bn in 2024, and on labour and capital costs it scores higher than 90% of the other economies.[1,5,6,7]

For context, Germany took 26.6% of its midstream wind exports of USD 10.8 bn in 2024, the Czech Republic 8.9% and the United States 8.1%. The paper's framework associates the Grow corner with export promotion.[2]

3. Sectoral priorities and the existing policy posture

The Strategic Index ranks Poland's own sectors by combining opportunity, security need, policy activity, the supply-chain stage and the technology's low-emission value. On the paper's weighting, it puts upstream nuclear 1st, upstream wind 2nd, downstream solar 3rd, upstream batteries 4th and midstream electric grid 5th among its own sectors. At 0.66, upstream nuclear leads by 0.022, with security need adding 0.244 and opportunity 0.163. The sectors after it are almost tied, with gaps of 0.009, 0.000 and 0.003. Policy activity accounts for the place of downstream solar, adding 0.168 to its score: on data-based priority, the Strategic Index without that term, it ranks 14th. Its high-priority sectors rank lower: downstream nuclear 14th, upstream gas 20th and upstream oil 26th. Its allied pick, the top upstream or midstream sector after a resource screen, is upstream wind, almost tied with upstream batteries; the screen removes upstream nuclear.[1]

Policy activity counts International Energy Agency Policies and Measures records and reads the Climate Action Tracker rating against each technology. Splitting its sectors into thirds on each measure, top priority meets the most policy in midstream electric grid, midstream batteries and midstream solar. Its 1st and 2nd sectors, upstream nuclear and upstream wind, are in the top third on data-based priority but in the "middle" policy group. No top-priority sector has the least policy. Bottom priority meets the most policy in downstream green hydrogen and the least in 7 sectors, every oil and coal sector among them. Poland carries the EU's Climate Action Tracker rating, Insufficient (November 2024); it has 205 Policies and Measures records of its own, 114 naming a technology. For context, Global Trade Alert lists 679 active industrial-policy measures for Poland, 525 of them EU-wide.[1,8,9,10]

4. Partnership priorities and why

The Partnership Strength Index rates partners from Poland's viewpoint as reliable suppliers (Friendshore), as export markets (Partnership Opportunity) and, for middle- and lower-income partners, by Development Potential. It ranks Germany 1st, the Czech Republic 2nd, the United States 3rd, the Netherlands 4th and Lithuania 5th of 190 partners. Germany, the Czech Republic and the Netherlands each stand out as an export market; for Germany the best sectors include midstream wind, midstream electric grid, upstream solar, upstream electric grid and midstream solar. The United States and Lithuania each stand out as a reliable supplier.[1]

Today's ties mostly follow these priorities. Germany, the Czech Republic and the United States are each a priority partner with strong ties today: on average across its energy-goods baskets they are its 1st, 3rd and 4th trade partners. Lithuania, by contrast, is a priority partner with few ties today, ranking 36th by trade. Each of these partners shares membership of NATO with Poland and votes in the same bloc at the UN. China ranks 2nd among its trade partners but 46th on Partnership Strength, and the countries vote in opposite blocs. Ukraine, its 5th trade partner, is a strong tie today that the index ranks lower, at 45th.[1,2,11,12]

As a partner to the coalition, Poland ranks 9th of 192 economies on Partnership Strength averaged over the core members' viewpoints. In the allied network design, which spreads upstream and midstream production across coalition members, its largest derived shares are 8.2% of midstream coal, 2.5% of upstream coal and 2.3% of midstream batteries.[1,13]

5. Data notes and caveats

The Country Insights page shows these data as of 12 October 2026.

- Scores compare Poland with other economies in the same sector; they are not measures of risk or profit in absolute terms.
- All index values are the paper's baseline as of 12 October 2026; Strategic Insights recomputes them under other weightings.
- Strategic Index scores within 0.01 of each other are almost tied: small changes in the data or the weights can swap their order.
- In the allied network design the European Union is one producer; Poland's shares are derived from its weight within the EU.
- The Climate Action Tracker rates the EU as a whole; Poland carries the EU's rating.
- Poland's counts leave out the EU's own 438 International Energy Agency policy records.
- Trade figures count trade with other EU members.
- Industrial-policy measures from the Global Trade Alert, New Industrial Policy Observatory, October 2026 extract (as of 5 October 2026) are context only, outside the Policy index.
- Each EU member carries the EU's announced 2035 manufacturing-capacity shares and electric-vehicle figures.

Sources

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13. Allied network design (the paper's model design of coalition production shares).
